by the Constituent Assembly as well as the adoption of Bharat in Article 1 of the Constitution.

To me, what is astounding is the dignity, poise and clarity with which scholars, such as Sarda, Mookerji, Sarkar and Majumdar, and their contemporaries presented their views on the antiquity and achievements of the Indic civilisation in the face of colonial hubris. To illustrate the atmospherics of the period, one need not look beyond a 21-page paper titled 'The Origins of Indian Nationalism According to Native Writers' authored by Bruce T. McCully, an American professor of history, in 1935, which was published in *The Journal of Modern History.*[28] The stated object of the study was 'to determine the origins of Indian nationalism as indicated in the works of native writers'. However, McCully's Eurocentrism reveals itself through his language that reeks of sheer condescension and contempt for the works of Mookerji and other 'native' voices, and is best captured in his own words:

> The attempt to interpret the unity of ancient India in terms of religion and culture, aside from the improbability of this theory in the light of historical research, appears to be more in the nature of a rationalisation to support the contention that India has always possessed certain of the component elements of nationality than an explanation of the origins of nationalism. …
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> …. With their somewhat romantic attachment to the past glories of India in contrast to the despised present, these writers seem to invite criticism by their cavalier disregard for the evidences of history.... Far more weighty in number, diversity, and value are the writings which attribute the origins of Indian nationalism to the influences, on the whole beneficent, flowing into India as a consequence of British rule.
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> …. The evidence indicates that an overwhelming majority of the writings examined prefer the latter thesis, thereby inclining to admit that Indian nationalism is not of indigenous origin but exotic, implanted not by native but by foreign hands, and germinating only under conditions and influences supplied by a foreign nation and people. It is equally apparent that a majority of the writers believe that the British supplied not only environmental and other factors necessary to evoke a national consciousness in India, but also the germ in the